

DEEP DIVE — US & International Grants

Map (verified 12 Jul 2026)

Non-equity money open to a Croatian feature doc in production, delivery Q4 2027. Full agent research; deadlines verified where possible, "not verified" flagged.

OPEN NOW

Fund	What	Deadline	Verdict
Doc Society Fund (global)	Feature docs, "better futures" framing	Rolling EOI, open now (apply.doc society.org)	Strong — cheap EOI, global, ocean-advocacy framing fits. Do this month.
Field of Vision	Commissions features/shorts, any stage	Rolling, no deadlines (fieldofvision.org/submit)	Good — the 2023 sports-justice/accountability story is their lane. Low-hours pitch.
Pulitzer Center	Journalism/short docs only, \$5–10k	Rolling	Marginal — only as companion short on the justice case.
POV CFE 2027 season	PBS acquisition, ~\$30k–250k, rough cut+	Jul 31, 2026 (not verified on page)	Skip this cycle (no rough cut) > target mid-2027 CFE for 2028 season. CPB defunded = US public TV money at risk.

OPENS LATER (calendar these)

- **The Whickers — £120,000 main award** (whickerawards.com): worldwide, **director's first 50'+ doc** — literally Tomo's profile. Next round ~Nov 2026–Jan 2027. (!) **Caps: budget <=£500k, other funding <=£350k — our €1.2M envelope breaches this. Pre-check email decides if it's alive (stage question too: "late dev/early production")**. Highest single-cheque EV *if* the caps question resolves.
- **Ford JustFilms** — \$100–200k, global, social-justice; fall open call (~Oct–Dec, 2026 dates not announced). Watch from Sept.
- **Sundance Documentary Fund** — \$50–100k prod/post, global; 2027 window closed Jun 2026; next May–Jun 2027 > notifies ~2028, only useful if delivery slips.
- **Sundance x Sandbox Fund** (science docs) — physiology-at-depth fits; next ~spring 2027. Also watch Sandbox x CPH:DOX Science Pitch Award 2027.
- **Points North Fellowship** — worldwide, early-career; ~Jan–Mar 2027 deadlines; Sept 2027 = edit-stage timing. Calendar it.
- **Doc Society Climate Story Fund** — \$40–125k; **2026 closed Jul 6 — missed by 6 days**; get on list for 2027 (materials double with the EOI above).
- **AFS Sports Documentary Residency (USC)** — 12 international filmmakers, US sports-media pitch access; 2027 edition unconfirmed (State-Dept funded). Watch Nov 2026.

- **Save Our Seas Ocean Storytelling Grant** — \$50k but SHORT film commission; viable companion short with Vito; next ~Nov 2026.
- IDA Pare Lorentz — themed + needs experienced team member; low priority. Nat Geo Society RFPs — watch, ocean/human-limits themes recur.

CLOSED / INELIGIBLE (don't waste hours)

Chicken & Egg (gender eligibility) · IDA Enterprise (paused) · ITVS (US-only + CPB collapse) · Threshold (invite-only) · BFI Doc Society (UK-only) · Hot Docs Blue Ice (Africa-only) · **IDFA Bertha (Croatia excluded — EU/MEDIA country)** · Cinereach (no submissions) · True/False True Life (pays subjects, not filmmakers) · **Sloan (docs ineligible — fiction only)** · Simons/Sandbox Films & HHMI (studios — pitch as industry, not grants) · Religion of Sports/Uninterrupted (commissioners via reps) · IOC/OFCH (no open grants; freediving not Olympic) · Redford Center (needs US team member; next 2028) · Waitt/Schmidt/Patagonia/Save The Waves (no open film funds verified).

TOP 3 THIS QUARTER (agent's ranking, endorsed)

1. **Whickers prep** — pre-check email NOW (budget caps + stage), taster reel, proposal draft ready for ~Nov opening.
2. **Doc Society Fund EOI** — submit this month; few hours; materials reusable for Climate Story Fund 2027.
3. **Build the Documentary Core Application package once** (synopsis, treatment, bios, USD budget, sample reel — the IDA/Sundance standard format JustFilms also uses) › every future US deadline becomes a one-day job. Then fire Field of Vision as the package's first live test; be ready the day JustFilms opens.

Calendar beyond: AFS watch (Nov 2026) · Save Our Seas short (Nov 2026) · Points North (Jan–Mar 2027) · Sundance/Sandbox (Apr–Jun 2027, contingency) · POV (Jul 2027 › 2028 season).